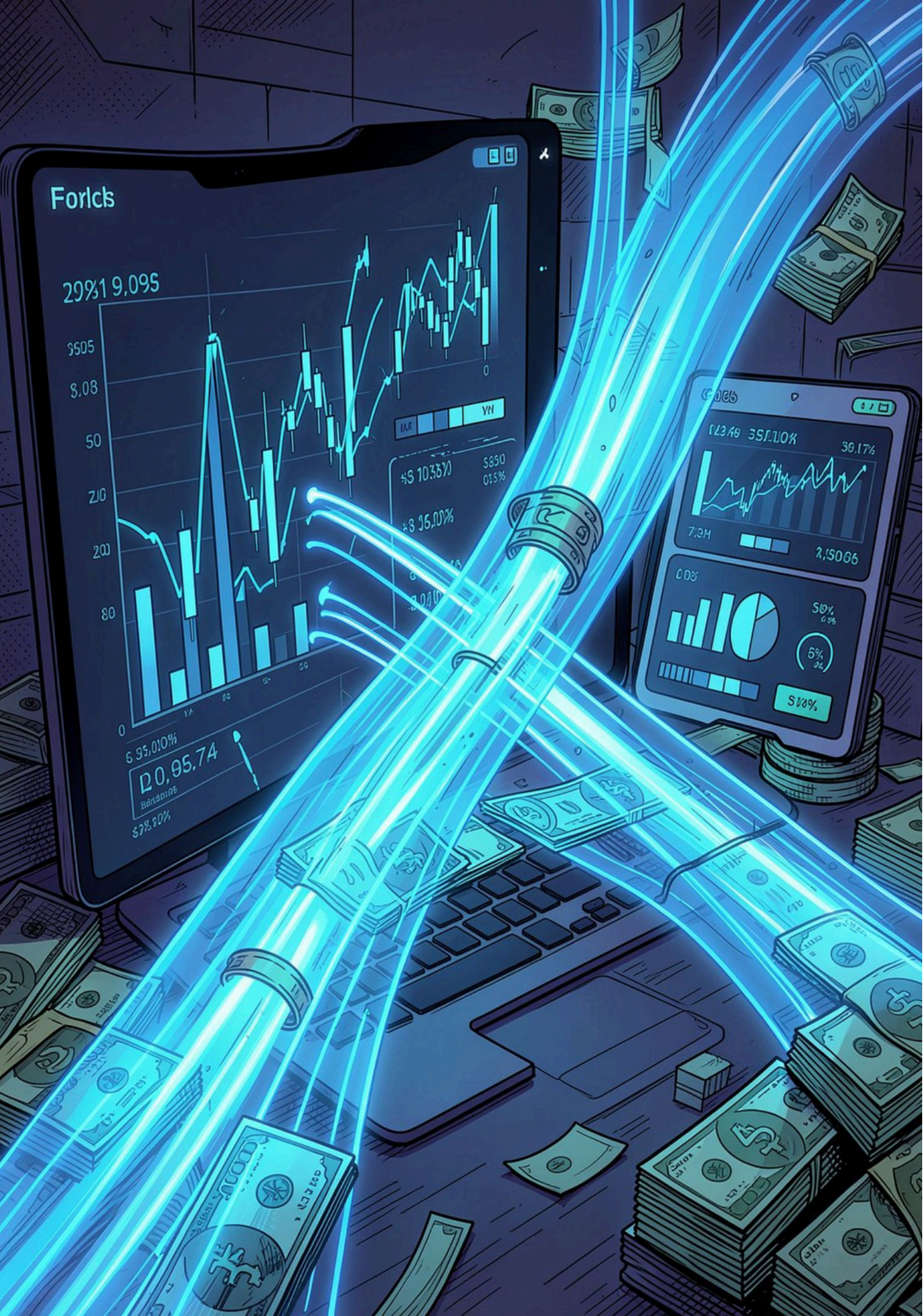




Billed vs. Banked: Where Does Our Money Really Go?

A story of tracking every dollar, from promise to payment.



The Problem

Imagine a company that sells monthly subscriptions. Every customer signs a contract saying how much they'll pay each month. But when the company checks its bank account at year-end, the number doesn't match what it should be. Some money is going missing along the way; nobody knows exactly where or why. This project is like detective work: follow every dollar from the moment a customer agrees to pay, all the way to the moment it actually lands in the bank, and catch exactly where it slips away.

Meet the Data

Five simple tables, with real record counts as stat callouts:

Customers

5,000 companies who signed up

Plan History

8,974 records of what plan and price each customer had over time

Invoices

126,852 bills sent, and whether they got paid

Support Tickets

45,658 complaints or questions customers raised

Marketing Spend

288 records of money spent to win new customers, by channel

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3	PuR	\$.60	\$900		0						
5	Tlo.A	\$.30	\$800								
7	Na: M	\$.R10	\$900		0						
6	Gunloef 165	\$.80	\$200		0						
7	Cealnef CEO	\$.70	\$900		0						
8	BaB	\$160	\$660		0						
16	Anchoif B60	\$100	\$830		0						
19	S	\$450	\$370		0						
10	Ptd	\$.80	\$880		0						

STEP 1

Cleaning the Data

Before trusting any answer, the data has to be honest first.

→ **Fill in the blanks**

Found missing info (like company size never recorded) and labeled it "Unknown" — no guessing.

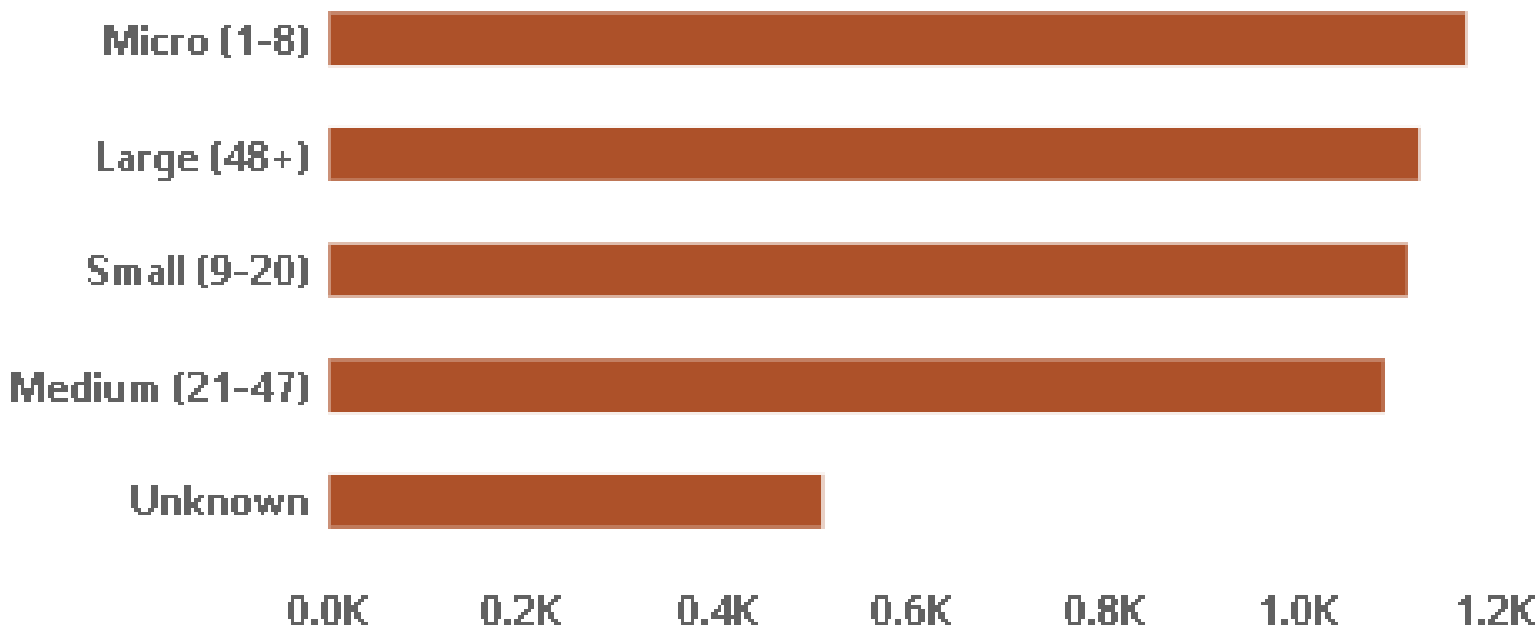
→ **Remove duplicates**

Checked for duplicate or broken records and cleaned them out.

→ **Build the foundation**

Created one clean master calendar: one row per customer, per month, showing exactly what plan they were on.

Cleaning the Data



Measuring the Leaks

For every customer, every month, we compared four numbers. Any gap between them is a **leak**. We built **23 measurements** across four areas.

1

Getting Customers

How much it costs to win one, and how fast it pays back

2

Pricing

Are we charging what we should?

3

Getting Paid

Of what we billed, how much did we actually collect?

4

Keeping Customers

Are they growing, shrinking, or leaving?

❏ Plus 4 Warning Signals, early clues a customer might leave soon.

What We Found: The Big Numbers

87.4%

Collection Rate

Of the \$98.8M we should collect,
We got \$86.4M

\$12.9M

Missing Money

62% unpaid bills, 34% billing gaps,
only 4% pricing

96%

Eventual Payment

Failed payments get paid, usually
within 31 days

25x

Cost Difference

Outbound Sales (\$2,815) vs. Referral
(\$110) to win a customer

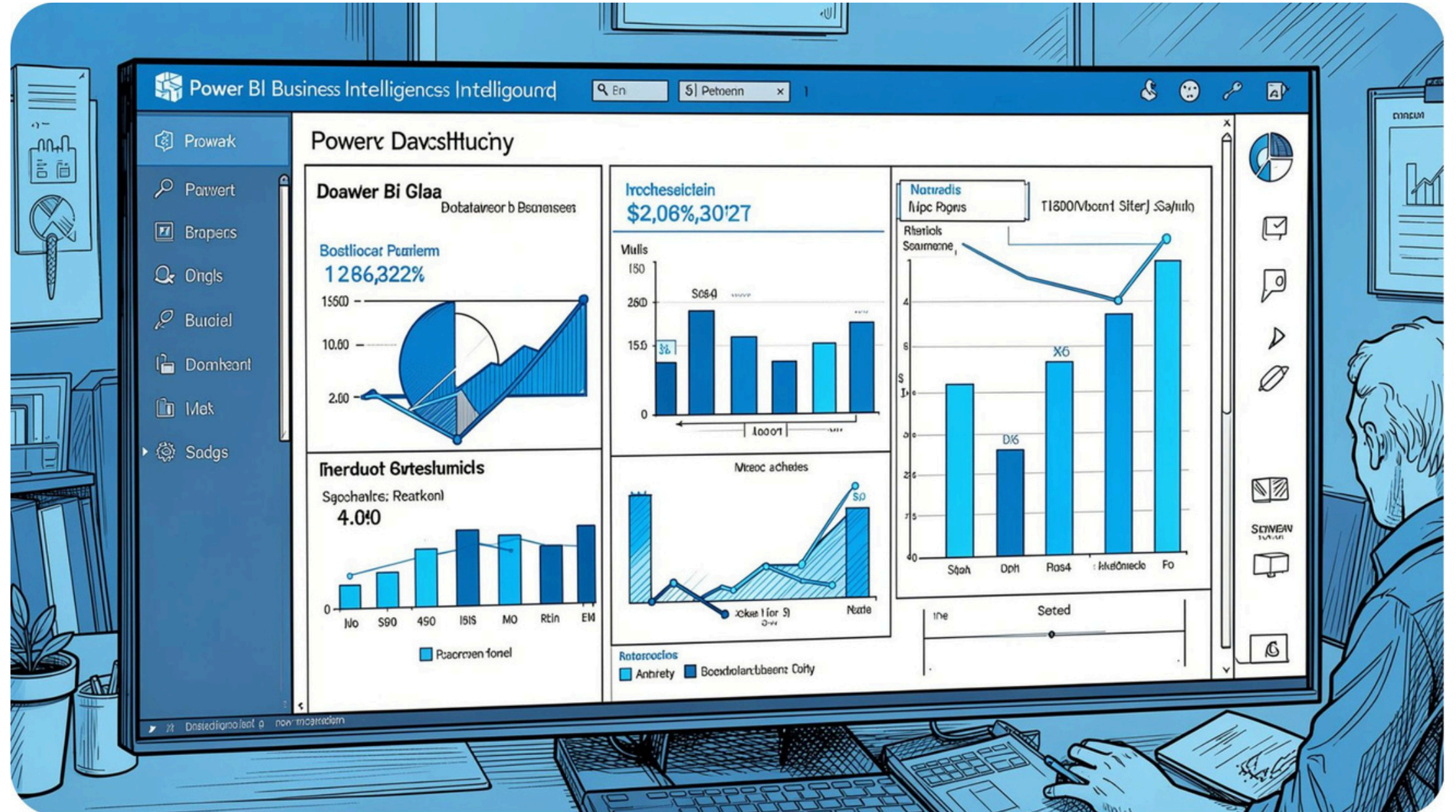
Real warning signs before a customer leaves: cutting seats (3x more likely)
and more support tickets (1.7x more likely). NOT real warning signs:
downgrading their plan, or having no account manager.



STEP 2

Turning Numbers Into Pictures

Once we had the numbers from SQL, we brought them into **Power BI** to turn them into charts anyone can read at a glance.



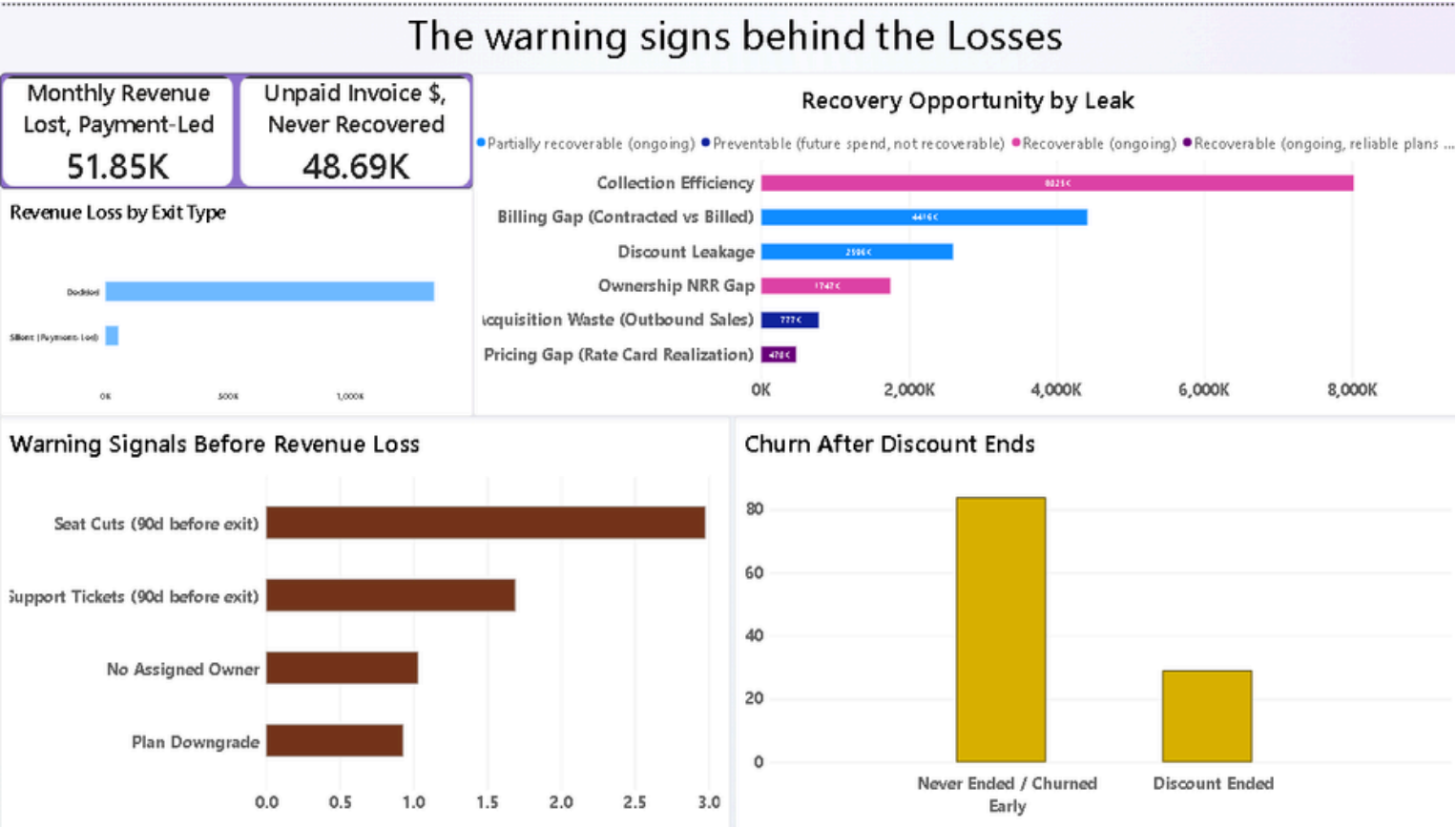
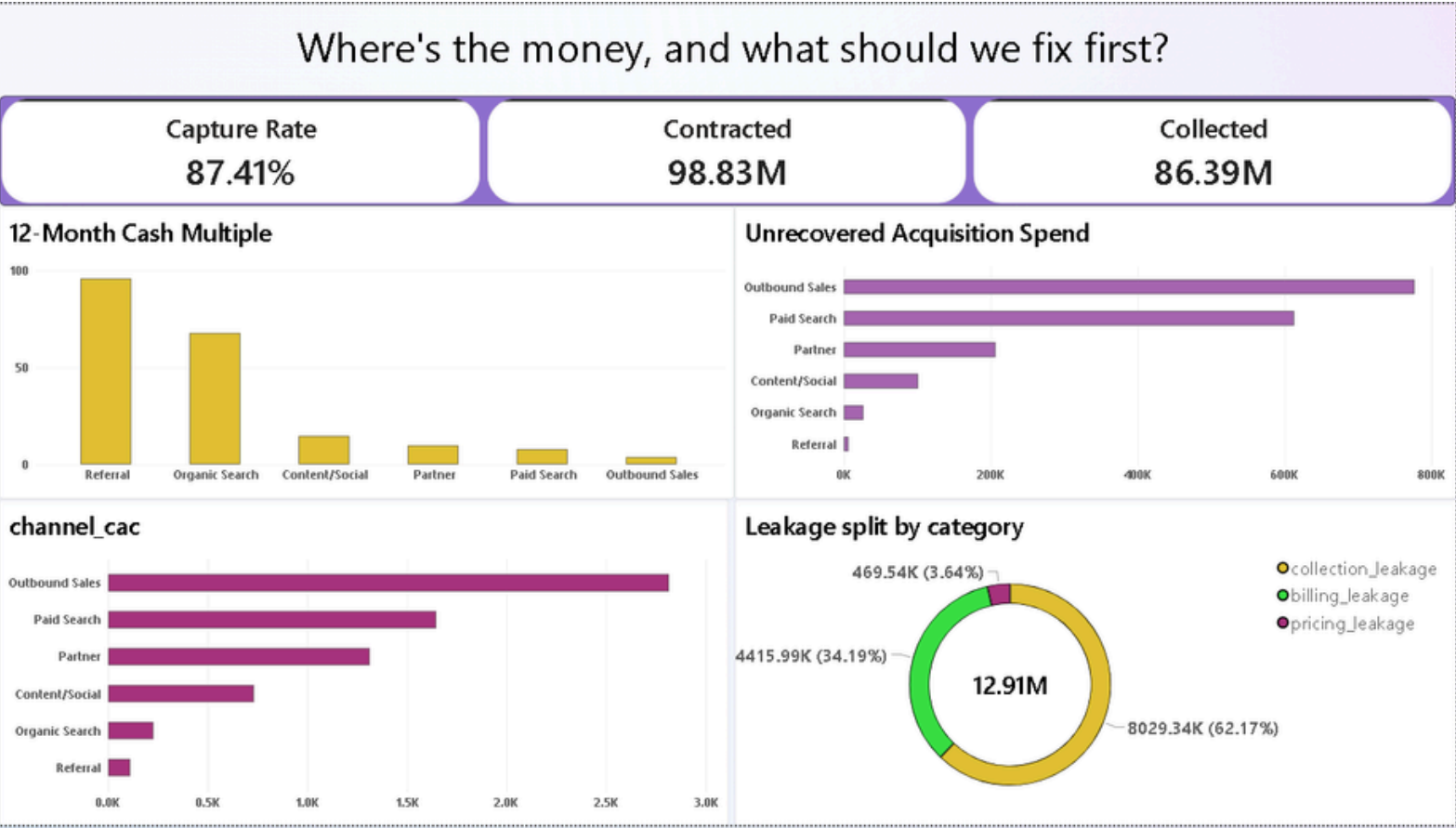
One connected model

All 23 KPIs linked together in a single system.

2-page interactive dashboard

Click a chart and everything else updates. One page drills straight into the other.

The Dashboard



Page 1: Where's the Money

Shows the full leak map, which marketing channel is worth using, and which single leak is worth fixing first.

Answer: Collections, an \$8 million opportunity.

Page 2: The Warning Signs

Shows which early-warning signs are real, and how much money we lose every month from customers who leave purely because a payment failed, not because they chose to.

The Hard Truths and What To Do

1 Collections is our biggest leak

Fix: Chase failed payments faster; most come back within 31 days if we just follow up.

2 Outbound Sales costs 25x more than Referral

Fix: Shift budget toward Referral and Organic Search instead.

3 Account managers don't actually stop customers from leaving

Fix: Review how account managers actually work, instead of assuming it already helps.

4 We were watching the wrong warning signs

Fix: Build alerts for the real ones — seat cuts and rising tickets — and reach out early.

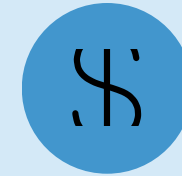


Summary



We Know Where the Leak Is

Exactly \$12.9 million is missing, and we know why.



Collections First

Fixing collections recovers the most money, fastest, with no new spend.



Real Warning Signs Exist

Build an alert system around seat cuts and rising tickets.



Rethink Outbound Sales

That spend needs a second look. Referral is far more efficient.

Thank you.